

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding? Answer Choices: A. Radial artery B. Ulnar artery C. Princeps pollicis artery D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The assistant is thinking about the fact that the anatomical snuffbox is a region on the wrist that contains a variety of structures, including blood vessels, tendons, and nerves. The region is also known for being a common site of injury, such as from a penetrating stab wound. The assistant is also thinking about the fact that the radial artery is a major blood vessel that runs through the anatomical snuffbox, and that damage to this artery can cause severe bleeding. The assistant is considering the fact that the bleeding may be caused by a variety of factors, such as the size of the wound, the depth of the wound, and the location of the wound. The assistant is also thinking about the fact that the vascular surgeon may need to use a variety of techniques, such as wound closure, suturing, and embolization, to treat the bleeding. </think> <answer> A . Radial artery </answer>

